

Honey Chili Crisp Game Day Wings

with Blue Cheese Toss Sauce • 2 lbs • Serves 3–4

Baked low-and-slow to render the fat, then blasted at high heat for crackly crispy skin. Tossed at the end in a bold sauce of Momofuku chili crisp, honey, and crumbled blue cheese — spicy, sticky, funky, and rich all at once.

Ingredients

For the wings:

For the blue cheese toss sauce:

2 lbs	whole chicken wings, split	1½ tsp	black pepper
2 tbsp	baking powder (NOT soda)	1½ tsp	garlic powder
2 tsp	kosher salt	1½ tsp	smoked paprika
5 tbsp	Momofuku chili crisp	2 tsp	rice vinegar
3 tbsp	honey	2 tsp	sesame oil
2 tbsp	soy sauce	115g (4oz)	blue cheese, crumbled

To finish: sesame seeds, sliced scallions

Instructions

1. Dry brine the wings

Split wings at the joint into flats and drumettes if whole. Pat every piece completely dry with paper towels — non-negotiable for crispy skin. Toss with baking powder, salt, black pepper, garlic powder, and smoked paprika until evenly coated. At 2 lbs you'll have a good number of pieces — use a large bowl and toss in batches if needed to coat evenly.

2. Air-dry in the fridge (strongly recommended)

Spread wings in a single layer on one or two wire racks over baking sheets and refrigerate uncovered for at least 1 hour, up to overnight. Don't stack or crowd them — airflow on all sides is what dries the skin. This step is the difference between good and great wings.

3. Low roast — 250°F for 30 minutes

Preheat oven to 250°F (120°C). At 2 lbs, use two baking sheets if needed — overcrowding is the enemy of crispy skin. Arrange wings skin-side UP on wire racks and roast 30 minutes. This slow stage renders the subcutaneous fat so the skin can fully crisp in the high-heat blast.

4. High roast — 425°F for 20–25 minutes

Crank oven to 425°F (220°C) and continue roasting 20–25 minutes, flipping once at the 10–12 minute mark. The wings are already partially cooked and fat-rendered from Stage 1, so they crisp up fast — don't walk away. Wings are done when deeply golden with visibly crackly, blistered skin. If using two pans, rotate them top-to-bottom at the flip.

5. Build the toss sauce

Whisk together chili crisp, honey, soy sauce, rice vinegar, and sesame oil in a large bowl — big enough to toss all 2 lbs comfortably. Once combined, fold in the crumbled blue cheese. Don't whisk it smooth — keep chunky pockets of blue cheese throughout. It will soften and melt slightly when the hot wings hit it.

6. Toss and serve

Pull wings from the oven and immediately transfer to the bowl. Toss hard to coat everything evenly — work quickly so the skin stays crispy. The heat from the wings loosens the sauce and helps it cling while the blue cheese melts just enough to get creamy without disappearing. Pile onto a platter, finish with sesame seeds and sliced scallions, and serve immediately.

Notes

- *Baking powder — not baking soda: Baking soda will make the wings taste metallic and soapy. Must be baking powder.*
- *Two pans at 2 lbs: Don't crowd a single pan. A single layer with space between each wing is essential — use two racks/pans and rotate them halfway through the high roast.*
- *Blue cheese choice: Gorgonzola is creamier and melts beautifully into the sauce. Roquefort is sharper and holds its shape for bigger bites of funk.*
- *Fold, don't whisk: Chunky blue cheese in the sauce means pockets of flavor in every bite rather than blending away.*
- *Toss right before serving: Sauced wings soften quickly. Toss and eat immediately for maximum crunch.*